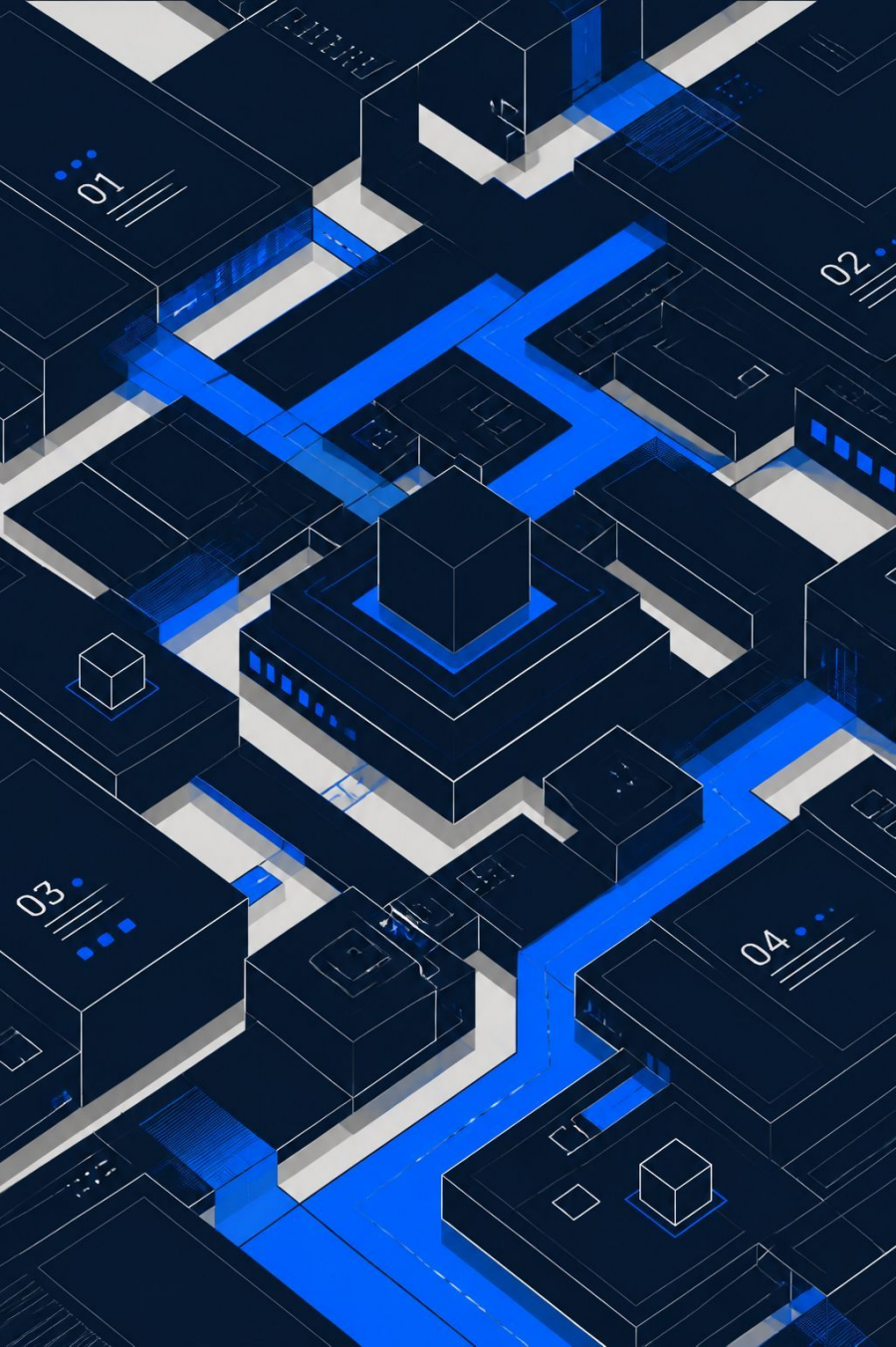




The AI Premium Is Overpriced

What 1,000 verified Micro-SaaS companies reveal about today's acquisition market

One marketplace. Thousands of signals. One investment opportunity.



1,000 Verified Companies

Revenue verified through payment APIs — high fidelity dataset (frozen Jul 30, 2026)



262 Actively Listed

Companies currently for sale — directly actionable acquisition pipeline

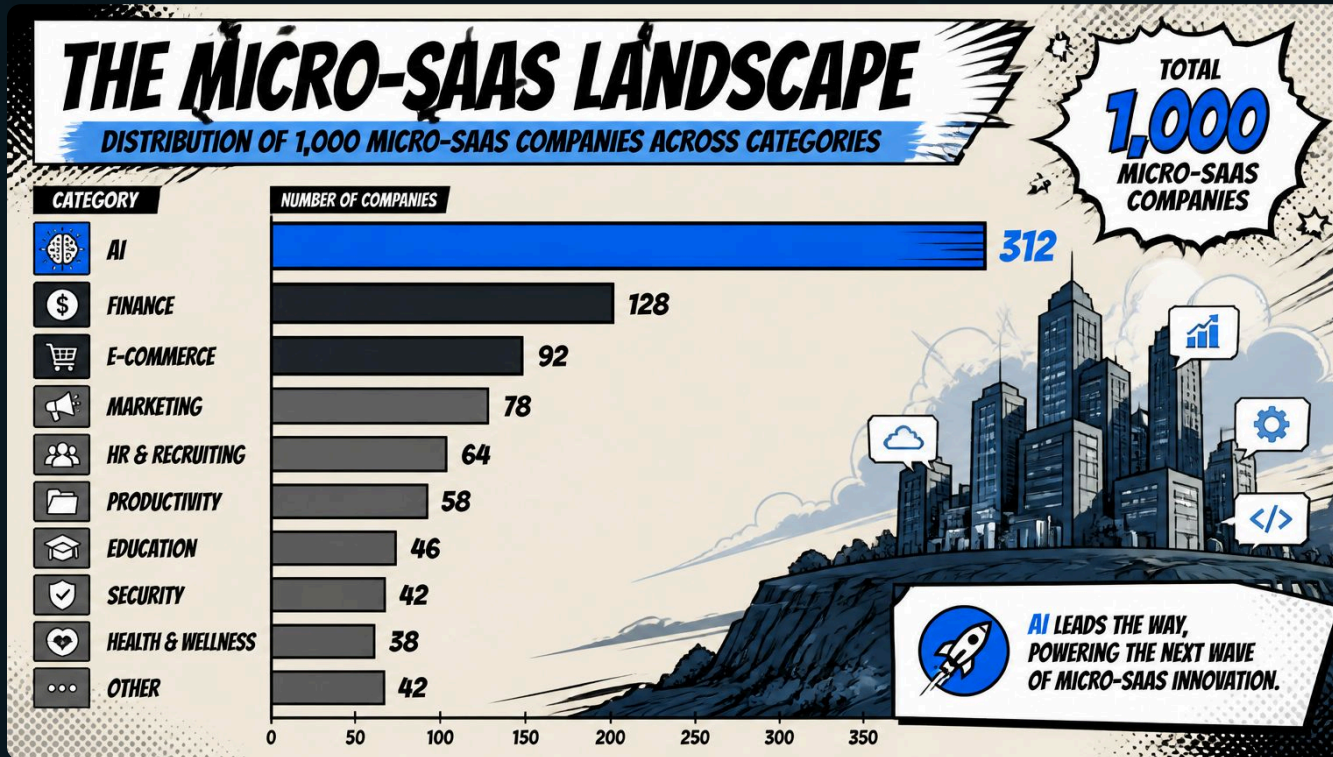


Key Signals

MRR, growth, asking multiples, pricing, category, launch date



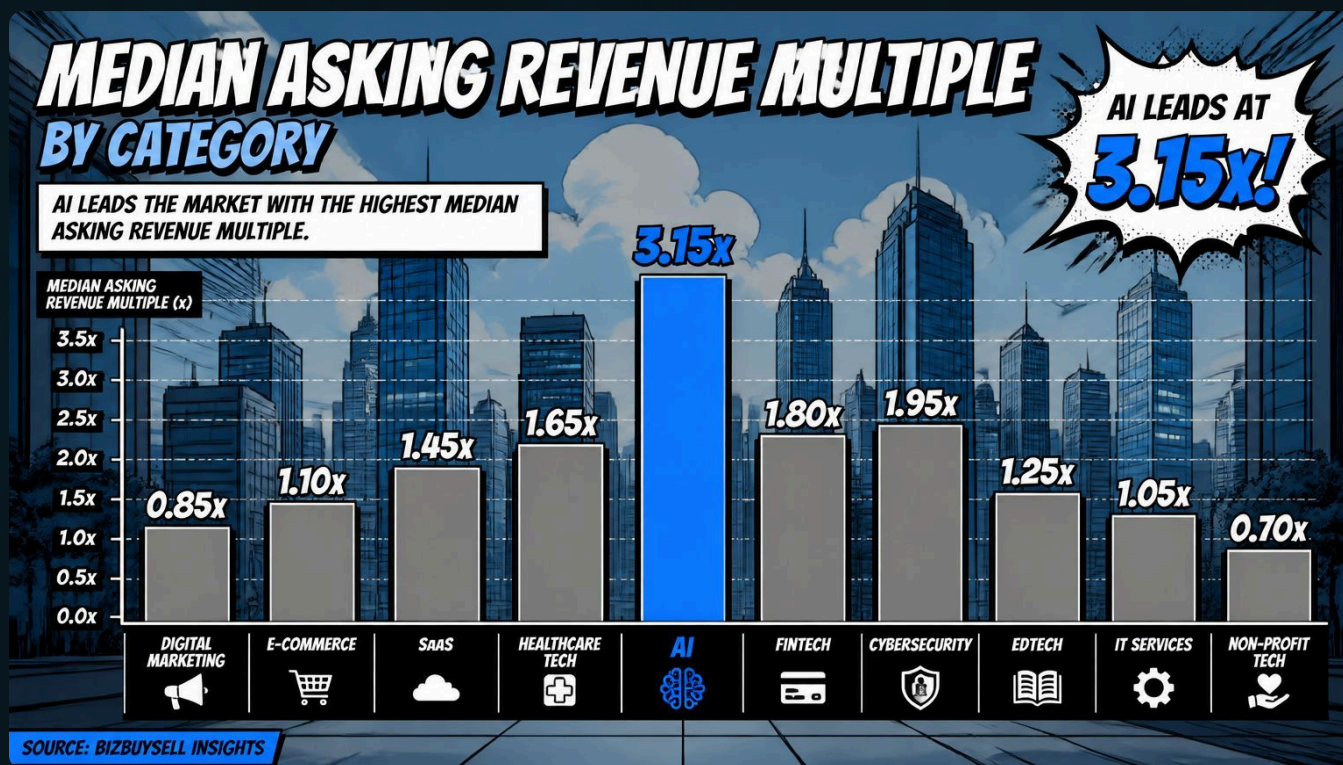
AI dominates the acquisition marketplace.



Snapshot

- AI is the largest single category by listings—54 active AI offers.
- Category leadership creates attention and capital concentration.
- High listing volume does not imply superior performance.

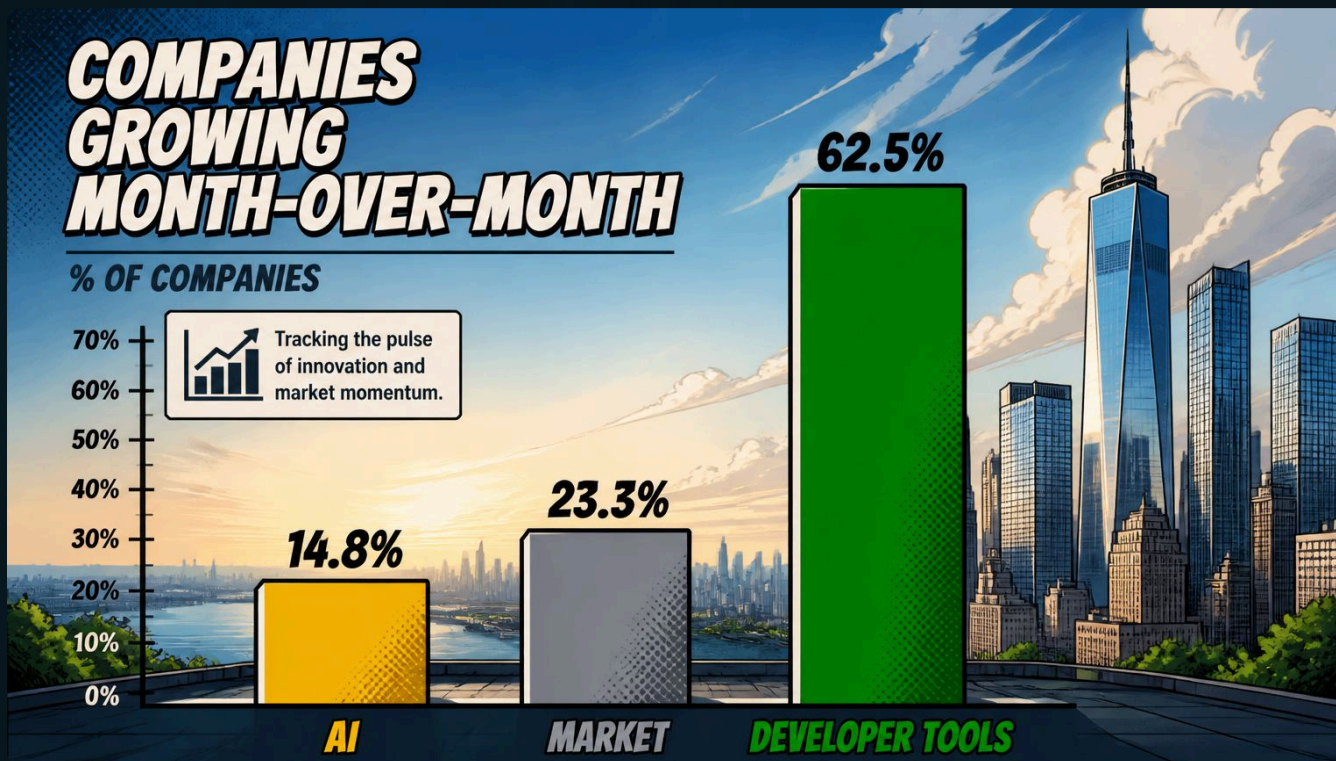
Investors are paying the highest premium for AI businesses.



Key data

- Median Asking Multiple — AI: 3.15× annual revenue
- Multiple premium concentrated in AI listings, despite wide variance
- Premium reflects narrative value as much as financials

The highest-priced category has the weakest growth profile.



Growth rates (monthly)

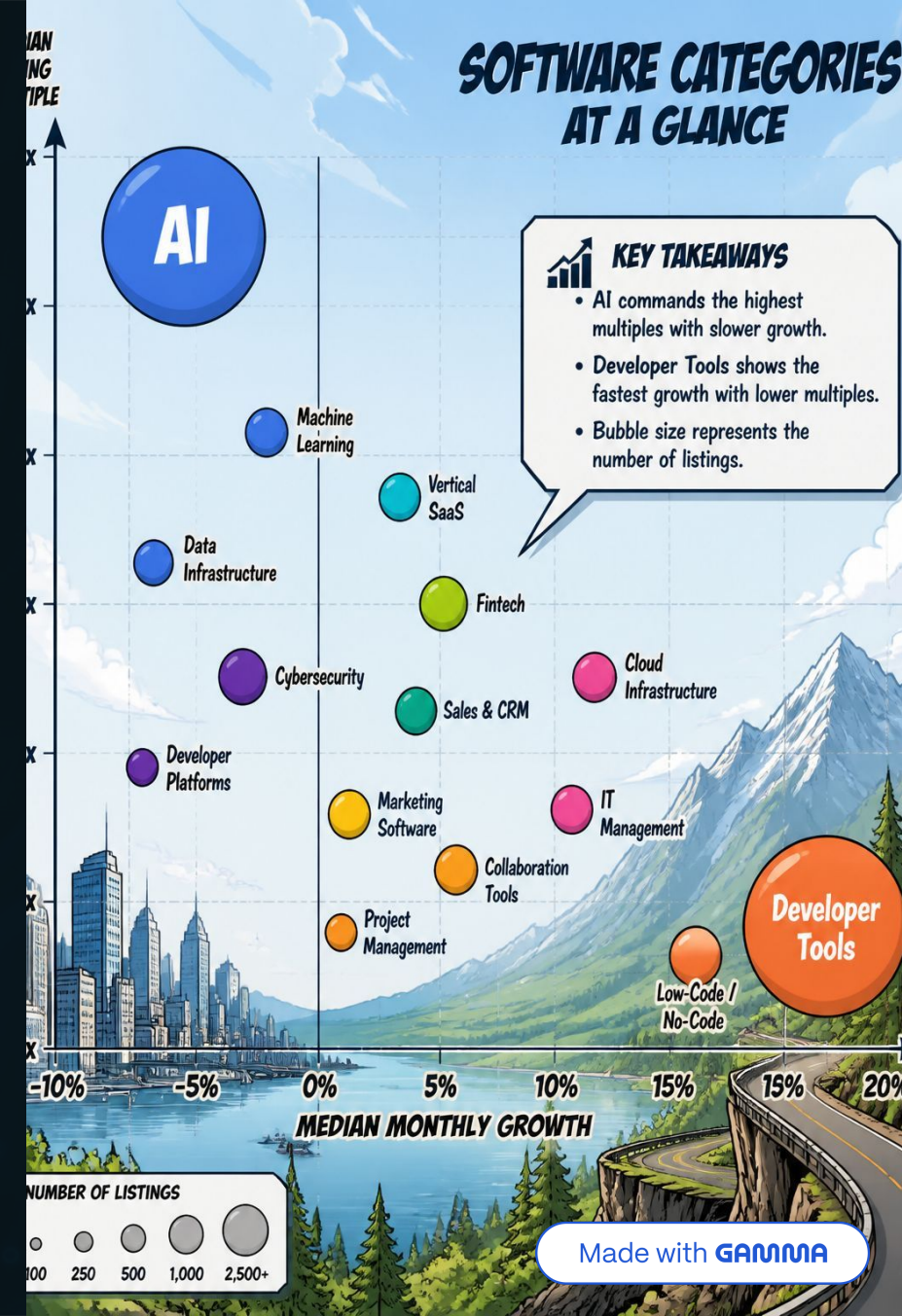
- AI: 14.8% of listed AI companies show month-over-month growth
- Market average: 23.3%
- Developer tools: 62.5% — materially stronger growth signal

❏ This is the "wait a second" moment: the narrative premium and observable growth diverge.

The market is pricing attention — not performance.

Valuation premium vs. growth: divergence is visible — bubbles sized by listing count to show market attention.

- ❶ Callout: "Valuation premium and growth premium have diverged — attention is concentrated where growth is weakest."



The Smart Money Buys Growth, Not Hype.



Premiums vs. Performance

AI commands premium multiples despite lower growth incidence.



High Growth, Lower Price

Developer tools show higher growth with more attractive multiples.



Asymmetric Opportunity

Mispricing creates buy-low, scale-fast acquisition windows.



A repeatable framework for identifying undervalued acquisitions.

CRITERIA	REVENUE GROWTH How quickly is revenue growing?	REVENUE MULTIPLE How attractive is the valuation?	MRR STABILITY How predictable & stable is MRR?	COMPETITION How intense is the competition?	RETENTION SIGNALS How strong is customer retention?	FOUNDER QUALITY How strong is the founding team?	CATEGORY TAILWINDS How favorable is the market tailwind?	TOTAL SCORE
WEIGHT	20%	15%	15%	10%	15%	15%	10%	(OUT OF 100)
COMPANY	135%	15x	93%	10%	15%	15%	10%	COMPANY
Northpeak AI Sales Platform	128% 	6.2x 	92% 	3/10 	94% 	9/10 9/10 	8/10 8/10 	86.3
Catalyst Customer Data Platform	92% 87% 	5.1x 	88% 	5/10 	89% 	9/10 8/10 	7/10 7/10 	75.6
Greenflow Sustainability Analytics	84% 64% 	4.3x 	85% 	7/10 	86% 	7/10 7/10 	9/10 9/10 	72.4
SecureSync DevSecOps Platform	98% 98% 	6.8x 	90% 	6/10 	91% 	9/10 9/10 	8/10 8/10 	81.1
Zentro Finance Automation Suite	45% 45% 	3.5x 	78% 	8/10 	80% 	6/10 6/10 	8/10 8/10 	61.2
Loopline Supply Chain Visibility	73% 73% 	4.9x 	84% 	6/10 	83% 	7/10 7/10 	7/10 7/10 	69.9
Summit Vertical SaaS Platform	98% 112% 	7.2x 	93% 	4/10 	83% 	9/10 8/10 	9/10 9/10 	87.2
WEIGHTED AVERAGE SCORE	86.7% 	5.4x 	87.1% 	5.6/10 	88.6% 	7.9/10 	7.7/10 	76.2 (OUT OF 100)

Scorecard (weights)

- Revenue Growth — 25%
- Revenue Multiple — 20%
- MRR Stability — 15%
- Customer Retention Signals — 15%
- Founder Quality — 10%
- Competition & Category Tailwinds — 15%

Ideal score: 100. Target acquisitions with high growth + sub-market multiples for asymmetric upside.

Where I'd deploy capital



1 — Developer Tools (Top pick)

Highest growth, fair valuations, strong technical moats — prime scale targets.



2 — Infrastruc ture

Stable recurring revenue, lower competition, consolidation opportunities.



3 — Productiv ity

Consistent demand, multiple monetization levers, defensible retention.



AI — Proceed with exception al diligence

Not all AI is overpriced — but median pricing demands rigorous validation of growth and retention before bidding.

Ranking rationale

1. Prioritize sustained growth at sensible multiples.
2. Prefer technical moat + low churn over narrative-driven demand.
3. Allocate initial capital to highest-score targets from the scorecard.

Risks, limitations, and final implication

1

Data Freeze

Dataset frozen July 30, 2026 — market moves quickly; re-check live listings before offers.

2

Marketplace Bias

Listed companies may skew toward sellers seeking narrative premiums.

3

Snapshot Growth

Monthly growth is a point-in-time signal — validate multi-month trends and cohort retention.

4

Median Hides Outliers

High-performing AI outliers exist; require deal-level diligence.

Final implication

Every investment must acknowledge uncertainty. The dataset shows systematic mispricing of narrative-driven categories. Prioritize fundamentals — growth, retention, and stability — and the asymmetric returns follow.

Data Source: TrustMRR dataset — July 2026